

Getting started guide

for healthy lifestyle promotion manual
and toolkit for youth



Acknowledgements

Special thanks to the Danish Red Cross and the Philippine Red Cross Society Health and Youth teams for their ongoing support, commitment and contributions to the development of the Healthy lifestyle promotion manual and toolkit for youth. Grateful acknowledgements to all peer educators and youth volunteers, who are helping to make the change we hope to create in the world.

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Contents of the materials in the Healthy lifestyle promotion manual and toolkit for youth

- Getting started guide
 - 20 lesson plans and tools targeting youth and peer educators
 - Peer educator guidance
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Learning objectives

As a result of the Healthy Lifestyles for YOUTh, participants will be better able to:

1. Demonstrate effective communication skills.
2. Identify the four NCDs of cancer, diabetes, cardiovascular disease (CVD) and chronic respiratory diseases (CRD).
3. Identify the four risk factors for NCDs.
4. Identify how they can consistently engage in healthy lifestyle behaviours.
5. Use appropriate techniques to positively influence peers.
6. Relate how to appropriately manage the consequences of NCDs on youth, family and friends.
7. Assess health behaviours and determine recommended actions.
8. Explain the importance of supportive environments for healthy living.

Audience for Healthy lifestyle promotion manual and toolkit

Healthy lifestyle promotion manual and toolkit for youth includes 20 session plans for use by Red Cross Red Crescent Youth volunteers and staff to teach about healthy lifestyles to youth in the school and community. The activities included allow volunteers and youth to learn the four principal NCDs, the dangers of NCDs, the behaviours that contribute to NCDs, the basics of behaviour change, assessing their NCD risk and developing a supportive environment to be able to implement the guidance given. These session plans build on the good work of the YABC (Youth as Agents of Behaviour Change) project, aiming to empower youth to change the unhealthy behaviour of themselves and their peers. These outcomes can be achieved with the highly interactive tools included in this toolkit. A breakdown of the suggested time required for the sessions is displayed in the lesson plan map table below.

Users of this material may include teachers in a school setting, Red Cross Red Crescent youth volunteers teaching the content peer-to-peer or to younger children. These materials are written as useable lessons for audiences aged 12—17. Refer to the “Audience” column in the lesson plan map to identify audiences for which each lesson plan is appropriate.

- YPE = Youth peer educators
- Y = Youth
- A = Adults
- a for A = can adapt for adults
- a for YC = can adapt for younger children

Adapting materials

To adapt materials for other audiences, the process requires:

- Active collaboration with the target audience to determine areas needing adaptation
- Propose modifications
- Test materials and approaches
- Revise and monitor

To adapt materials for age, culture, gender and/or literacy level, a team would start by reviewing existing material with adequate representation from the target audience. If there is more than one group (culture, sex, age, religion) for which material needs to be adapted, it is critical that at least two representatives from each type of group be part of the adaptation process. If adapting for very young children, invite early childhood teachers to join the group to represent appropriateness for young children.

To start:

- Provide hard copies of the specific lesson plans that might be adapted.
- Provide a five minute session to simply define the four risk factors of unhealthy diet, physical inactivity, tobacco use and excess alcohol.

Active collaboration with the target audience to determine areas needing adaptation

- Either teach the lesson plan as written OR ask the group to read once through the material on their own.
- Ask:
 - ◇ What is your general reaction to this draft?
 - ◇ For whom do you think this material or product is meant?
 - ◇ Which material do you think is easiest to understand?
 - ◇ Which material do you think shows a situation closest to your life?
 - ◇ Which material presents the most believable message?
 - ◇ If you were to use this material to teach to your culture/age group/gender/religion, which material and/or methods would you like to keep?
 - ◇ If you were to use this material to teach to your culture/age group/gender/religion, which material and/or methods would you get rid of?
- Give each individual a marker and sticky notes. Individuals representing a unique culture/age group/gender/religion group may work together. Instruct the group to review the material and highlight the text, images and/or methods that do not apply or are inappropriate to their culture/age group/gender/religion. They should place a sticky note on top and write alternative text or draw an alternative image that could be used. If the method is inappropriate, they may suggest a more suitable method.

Propose modifications

- Using the inputs from the teams, work together to revise the materials per their suggestions. If appropriate, allow the target group to work with the team to make the edits for their adaptation.

Test materials and approaches

- Using the adapted materials, test all materials with a sample of the target group. They should be used by a facilitator familiar with or from that same culture/age group/gender/religion.
- After each section of material, ask the audience:
 - ◊ What did you learn?
 - ◊ What did you like?
 - ◊ What did you not like?
 - ◊ What would you change in the materials or the method?
 - ◊ After the testing, query the facilitator using the same questions.

Revise and monitor

- Revise the materials using the feedback received. If appropriate, ask the facilitator to help revise the materials to a final version.
- Monitor how the target group responds to the materials. Revise again if needed

Where do I start?

The lesson plan map below details the learning objectives for the Healthy lifestyle promotion manual and toolkit for youth. These lesson plans can be taught sequentially or according to the knowledge and skills needed for a specific lesson or session. The toolkit is designed to align with school curriculum specifically in the areas of:

- Health education on proper nutrition, smoking and alcohol
- Advocating proper nutrition – canteen, sari-sari stores surrounding the schools to cease selling cigarettes and alcohol to minors
- Advocating against smoking and drinking alcoholic beverages
- Dissemination of advocacy messages and materials for and between students, parents, school personnel and community

Lesson plan map			1. Identify the four NCDs of cancer, diabetes, CVD and CRD	2. Identify the four risk factors for NCDs
	Audience	Time		
Behaviour change DOs&DON'Ts	YPE; Y; a for A	30-45 min		
Behaviour change stages	YPE; Y; a for A	45 min		
Collaborative negotiation	YPE; Y; a for A	90 min		
Effective communication	YPE; Y	60 min		
Environmental scan	YPE; Y; a for A	75 min		
Gender in healthy lifestyles	YPE; Y; a for A	90 min		
Healthy foods debate	YPE; Y	90 min		
Healthy lifestyle game show	YPE; Y; A	60 min		
Healthy lifestyle relay	YPE; Y; a for YC	45-60 min		
Name that activity	YPE; Y; a for YC	30-40 min		
Name that risk factor	YPE; Y; a for A	45-60 min		
Supportive environments	YPE; Y; a for A	60 min		
Peer pressure	YPE; Y	45 min		
Personal resilience	YPE; Y; a for A	90 min		
Playing my role	YPE; Y; a for A	90 min		
Project artwork	YPE; Y	120 min		
Someone else's shoes	YPE; Y	45 min		
Special effects	YPE; Y; a for A	45 min		
Telephone	YPE; Y; A	30-40 min		
Action plan template	YPE; Y; A	20-30 min	The action plan is to be used at the end of every lesson.	

[illegible]

Time required

The materials in this toolkit are flexible and are not necessarily designed to be taught in sequential order. Content from one activity does not always build on other activities UNLESS specifically indicated on the activity guidance. Each lesson plan in this toolkit ranges from 45—120 minutes required for the full experience. The times for each individual lesson are listed in the lesson plan map table above.

How do we know that the materials are working?

The lessons are designed to teach knowledge, skills and behaviours and the assessment of learning is integrated into the design of the lessons. Read each of the learning objectives featured in each individual lesson plan – these are the observable actions the facilitator or trainer should be able to see each learner actually demonstrate. For example, for the lessons with the learning objective of “Demonstrate effective communication skills”, there is an opportunity to actually demonstrate effective communication skills. This is something that can be physically observed. By teaching all of the lesson plans with this same learning objective, the learning objective of demonstrating effective communication skills becomes concretized and retained in the learner’s mind and skillset. There are many lesson plans that contribute to each learning objective to allow the learner to observe and demonstrate the complexities of the knowledge, skill and behaviour required to achieve that learning objective. Learning is layered on top of previous learning to improve the likelihood of retaining that content.

